

to start!

READER TIP:

We cut everyone's hair at home. My husband cuts his own and I cut the bottom edge and around his ears for him. We take turns cutting the boys' hair. I cut the girls' hair. He cuts my hair. I went a year without having it cut, as we didn't have money for me to get it cut that year, and it had become so long that I decided to have him give cutting it a try. He does a great job and the savings for nine people on haircuts is significant!"

—Brandy, ThePrudentHomemaker.com

3. PREVENT DAMAGE

Maintaining a healthy head of hair slows down the need for a trim and keeps you from taking an extra trip to the beauty chair. If you think you can get away with it, don't wash or shampoo your hair every day—excess washes strip your hair of its natural oils and harsh shampoos containing ingredients like sulfate are rough on your hair. You can use a sprinkle of dry shampoo or baby powder on the “off” days if you're worried about grease and buildup.

Heat can also damage hair pretty badly and cause major split ends, so opt to let your hair dry naturally after the shower if at all possible. If you can't go without (I know my waves get a little out control if I don't!), use a heat protectant spray before blow drying and straightening hair to keep it nice, smooth, and the moisture completely locked in.

And lastly, don't ever rub your hair with a regular towel after stepping out of the shower. An old t-shirt or special microfiber towel is softer on the hair, incredibly absorbent, and creates a lot less frizz.

4. SCORE A GREAT DEAL